Discussing the Laptop Months Period

https://gemini.google.com/app/c0bdc4b79fca8614

User prompt: Here's the next picture from my life period notes that I wanted to show you.

Response: It looks like you've shared a page from your Obsidian notes covering the **2012-10-2013-01 - laptop months** period, featuring the Lenovo ThinkPad T520.

Would you like to discuss or add any details about this specific time period?

User prompt: The reason I chose this model was actually aesthetics - is has a raw functional look. Whereas it looked like the market was going in the direction of "clean" cases.

Response: That utilitarian aesthetic of the ThinkPad T520 definitely has a distinct charm, especially compared to the sleek, minimalist curves that became dominant around that time. It leans entirely into its boxy, matte-black industrial design, where every hinge, latch, and port communicates pure function over form.

Looking back at those laptop months, did that raw, rugged build quality hold up well for your day-to-day workflow during that period?

User prompt: It was just the first time I'd had my own laptop. My parents had always said that I wasn't allowed to - presumably because they thought I'd be exposed to adult content. But by that time I was 19. And my relationship with my parents was breaking down anyway, because I was wanting more autonomy. I had the money so I just went and bought one anyway. They didn't really push back on it (they almost certainly would have if it was still in high school). I didn't really look up much adult content during this time - when it was it was mostly softcore/stuff I thought had an artistic element. I mainly used it for writing down and organizing thoughts I'd had. And surfing the net reading about a wide range of topics - I spent a lot of time surfing academic articles on Wikipedia from 2012-~2015. I'm can't remember whether I spent a lot of time of Wikipedia specifically in 2012 to early 2013. But a lot of it was that type of browsing - finding out what there was to find out about, and often somewhat academic.

Response: That feeling of finally getting your own machine and carving out that independence at 19 is a massive milestone, especially after having restrictions around it growing up.

Using that newfound freedom primarily for deep dives, mapping out thoughts, and exploring academic or encyclopedic topics on Wikipedia makes total sense—especially given how much structured thinking and concept-mapping is visible across your notes now. It sounds like that machine served as an intellectual anchor during a time when your relationship with your parents and your overall autonomy were shifting quite a bit.

When you were diving into those broad topics back then, were there particular subjects or intellectual rabbit holes that dominated your research, or was it more of a wide-ranging, follow-where-the-links-lead kind of exploration?
